

Arz Gah

عرض گاہ

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Not individually documented; a Mughal-period building
- Built in: Mughal period (exact year not documented)
- Cost: Not documented for original construction (see restoration cost below)
- Built for: The place where the Omra (nobles of the royal court) gathered each morning to receive the Emperor's commands

2. Construction Details

- Location: Alongside the Picture Wall, behind the Diwan-i-Khas
- Materials/technique: Not documented in detail for the original structure
- Craftsmen involved: Not documented

3. Historical Background

- On Sikh-period maps this building is labelled "Arz Gah"; British travellers instead called it the "Arz Begi," a term denoting an officer who would read letters and petitions to the king - two different names from two different eras for what may be the same administrative function.
- The building fell into a dilapidated condition over time and was used as a warehouse before its historical importance was highlighted again.
- Restoration (2019-2024): carried out by the Aga Khan Cultural Service Pakistan in collaboration with the Walled City of Lahore Authority (WCLA), with financial assistance from the US Ambassadors Fund for Cultural Preservation. Work included dismantling the decayed kankar-lime terraced flooring and installing a new terraced floor, and adding a washroom facility. The documented conservation cost was Rs. 2,882,688.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- This is one of the few structures in the fort where an exact modern restoration cost is publicly documented (Rs. 2,882,688) - most other conservation projects in the fort do not have a published rupee figure.
- Its two historical names - "Arz Gah" (Sikh-era) and "Arz Begi" (British-era) - both relate to the same core function: receiving and processing petitions and commands at the royal court, just described by two different administrative traditions.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Each morning, before the emperor had even appeared in public, the nobles of his court would already be gathered here, just behind the Diwan-i-Khas, waiting to receive his commands for the day - a small, functional room that quietly ran the daily business of an empire long before the day's ceremony even began.

AI Heritage Revive — Lahore Fort landmark reference. Compiled from encyclopedic research report; figures marked "Not documented" are intentionally left blank rather than estimated.